HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I must have done something to deserve this"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I must have done something to deserve this." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What specifically do I think I did?
- ☐ Would I say a friend deserved the same illness?
- ☐ What did Jesus say about suffering and sin?
- ☐ What has been forgiven and what do I carry?
- ☐ What caused my illness according to my doctors?
- ☐ How can I put down self-blame?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Suffering is not always deserved.
- ☐ Jesus rejects the equation.
- ☐ I am forgiven in Christ.
- ☐ God knows my frame.
- ☐ I can put down self-blame.
- ☐ He is with me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ John 9:3
  "Jesus answered, 'Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him.'"
- ☐ Ezekiel 18:20
  "The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him."
- ☐ Luke 13:4
  "Or those eighteen who were killed when the tower of Siloam collapsed on them: Do you think that they were more sinful than all the others living in Jerusalem?"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Self-blame lifted: Each week, note one thought of self-blame you replaced.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, John 9:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus rejects the simple link between suffering and sin.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Guilt/Shame" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Write the charge. State what you blame yourself for.
- ☐ Speak to yourself as to a friend. Rewrite it kindly.
- ☐ Confess if needed. Receive forgiveness.
- ☐ Talk with a counselor. Work through guilt.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I must have done something to deserve this": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Self-blame lifted
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I must have done something to deserve this.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I search my past for a reason. Free me from false guilt, forgive what is real, and comfort me in my suffering. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.